



Pride of the nation: Double Olympic-medallist Manu Bhaker received the Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna award (above, right) for her resounding success at the Paris Olympics. RITU RAJ KONWAR & PTI

event and ordered broccoli soup and a cup of milk with a dash of honey.

"The cherry on top is that I love doing it (staying fit)," she chirps.

There are other things from which Manu derives pleasure as well. She reads a lot; Dr. Brian Wess' *Many Lives, Many Masters* is keeping her occupied these days. Other than that, she has currently taken a liking to Rishab Rikhram Sharma's "calming yet strong" sitar instrumentals.

She has also perfected the art of playing the violin and horseriding,

two things she turns to after exhausting sessions at the range.

As the car designated to take Manu and her mother to the airport arrives, the chauffeur instantly recognises his illustrious passenger.

Within seconds of loading the luggage, he requests a selfie, and Manu smiles and obliges.

Perhaps politely declining is one of the few skills she has yet to master.



Cheat day meal (except aloo paratha)

C'mon *yaar*, it's always gonna be aloo paratha! But I barely get cheat days, so I've made peace with healthy food. Still, when I do cheat, parathas it is!

Actor for your biopic

Whoever can do justice to my character. Not sure yet—maybe people can suggest, or you can help. Whatever...

Dream concert?

Top pick: Arijit Singh! Also love Karan Aujla and Rishab Sharma's Indian classical setup